



In and out

The inside wall of the small intestine has a very bumpy surface.

EATING

Food is the fuel that provides energy for your body. The energy is measured in units called calories. Before your body can use the food you eat, it has to

be broken down into tiny bits that are small enough to pass into your blood. This digestion takes about 24 hours, as the food flows through a long tube winding all the way from your mouth to your bottom.

1. Food starts being digested in your mouth. Your spit, or saliva, has a digestive juice which starts to break down the food.

Your liver is a "chemical factory." It also stores vitamins.

Windpipe

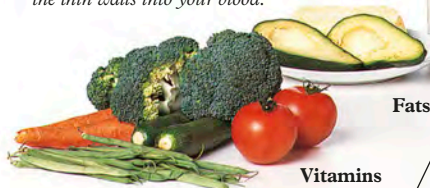
2. The food travels down a food pipe called the gullet.

3. Your stomach is a thick bag. Food is churned up inside it and mixed with strong stomach juices to make a kind of soup.

4. After leaving your stomach, your food flows down your small intestine. Goodness from the food seeps through the thin walls into your blood.

Large intestine

Small intestine



Vitamins and minerals

Get into groups!

Foods can be put into groups. Fats and carbohydrates provide you with energy. Vitamins and minerals keep you healthy. Proteins build cells and help your body to grow and repair itself.

Fats



Proteins

5. Your large intestine takes back the water from digested food. Later it is passed out of your body through your anus.

6. Your bladder stores urine. When it fills up you need to go to the bathroom to empty it.